

★ STAAR Science Lesson Plans ★

5 Hands-On Lab & Activity Lessons

Grades 5 & 8 | Teach4Texas

⚠️ PREVIEW — Sample pages only

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⚠️ PREVIEW — Full Lesson 1 Sample

Lesson 1: Ecosystem Escape Room 🔒

Grade: 5th **TEKS:** 5.12A, 5.12B **Duration:** 60 minutes **Materials:** 5 "Lock Stations" (envelopes with puzzles), ecosystem picture cards, food chain/food web diagrams, "Escape Room Passport," colored pencils, timer

Learning Objective

I can describe how energy flows through an ecosystem from producers to consumers to decomposers, and explain how organisms depend on living and nonliving components.

STAAR Connection

STAAR Science frequently tests **food chains/webs, energy flow, and ecosystem relationships.**

Warm-Up (8 minutes): "Ecosystem Brainstorm Race"

Teams of 4 fill quadrants: PRODUCERS | CONSUMERS | DECOMPOSERS | NONLIVING THINGS

2-minute timer — brainstorm as many examples as possible.

Key vocabulary:

- **Producer:** Makes own food using sunlight
- **Consumer:** Eats other organisms (herbivore, carnivore, omnivore)
- **Decomposer:** Breaks down dead organisms

- **Ecosystem:** All living and nonliving things interacting together

Main Activity (30 minutes): "The Great Ecosystem Escape"

5 stations around the room. Teams solve puzzles to get codes.

Station 1: "Energy Flow Decoder"

Arrange organisms into a food chain: Cards: Hawk, Grasshopper, Sun, Grass, Frog **Answer: Sun → Grass → Grasshopper → Frog → Hawk**

Follow-up: Which is the producer? Primary consumer? Where does ALL energy originate? **CODE = Number of consumers (3)**

Station 2: "Food Web Mystery"

Food web diagram: Grass → Rabbit → Fox; Grass → Mouse → Snake → Hawk; Grass → Grasshopper → Frog → Snake; Dead organisms → Mushrooms

Questions: Name two organisms that eat grass. If mouse population disappeared, what happens to snakes? What role do mushrooms play? **CODE = Arrows pointing TO the snake (2)**

Station 3: "Nonliving Factors Challenge"

Match scenarios to nonliving factors (temperature, water, sunlight, soil/minerals). **CODE = Scenarios where WATER is the factor (2)**

Stations 4-5 + final challenge in full version...

★ Get the Full Version! ★

STAAR Science Lesson Plans — All 5 Labs + Safety Guidelines

Complete lab procedures, real-world connections, STAAR practice questions, and answer keys.

Available on Teachers Pay Teachers

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